INCH-POUND

MIL-DTL-14650B
w/AMENDMENT 1
20 April 2004
SUPERSEDING
MIL-DTL-14650B
18 November 1998

DETAIL SPECIFICATION

STREAMERS, GENERAL SPECIFICATION FOR

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the general requirements for streamers used on Armed Forces flags and guidons (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. The streamers covered by this specification will be the following types, sizes, classes, and styles:

Type I - Streamer Set (See applicable specification sheet.)
Type II - Individual Streamers

Class 1 - Army (Specification Sheet 1)
Class 2 - Marine Corps (Specification Sheet 2)
Class 3 - Navy (Specification Sheet 3)
Class 4 - Air Force (Specification Sheet 4)
Class 5 - Unit Awards (Specification Sheet 5)
Class 6 - Coast Guard (Specification Sheet 6)

Size 1 - 2-3/4 inches wide and 4 feet long
Size 2 - 2-3/4 inches wide and 3 feet long
Size 3 - 1-3/8 inches wide and 2 feet long

Style - See applicable specification sheet for style number.

1.3 Classification. **DELETED**

Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to The Institute of Heraldry, Department of the Army, ATTN: Technical and Production Division, 9325 Gunston Road, Building 1466, Room S-112, Ft. Belvoir, VA 22060-5579 or emailed to Stanley.Haas@tioh.belvoir.army.mil. Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using the ASSIST Online database at www.dodssp.daps.mil.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of documents cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government documents.

2.2.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract (see 6.2).

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

A-A-52094 - Thread, Cotton
V-T-285 - Thread, Polyester **DELETED**

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE

MIL-DTL-11589 - Ribbon, Awards, General Specification for
MIL-DTL-32072 - Thread, Polyester

STANDARDS

FEDERAL **DELETED**

FED-STD-751 – Stitches, Seams and Stitching **DELETED**

SPECIFICATION SHEETS

(See ASSIST database for list of specification sheets.)

(Copies of these documents are available online at http://assist.daps.dla.mil/quicksearch/ or www.dodssp.daps.mil or from the Standardization Document Order Desk, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.2.2 Other Government documents, drawings and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

DRAWINGS

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY

5-5-2 - Streamers, Unit Decorations, Campaign, War Service and Conflict, Infantry and Medical
5-5-2A - Streamer Devices

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5-5-614 - Letters and Numerals for Streamers

UNITED STATES MARINE CORPS

75C5023A0000
75C5023A0001

(Figures 1, 2, and 3 . . ..) **DELETED**
(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and specification sheets required by the contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.3 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract (see 6.2).

(Non-government standards and other publications are normally available . . ..) **DELETED**

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR QUALITY

ANSI/ASQC Z1.4 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

(ASQ publications can be obtained from the American Society for Quality, 600 North Plankinton Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53203-2914 or www.asq.org.)

ASTM INTERNATIONAL

ASTM-D6193 - Standard Practice for Stitches and Seams

(ASTM publications can be obtained from ASTM International, 100 Barr Harbor Drive, West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959 or www.astm.org.)

THE COLOR ASSOCIATION OF THE UNITED STATES

The Standard Color Reference of America, Tenth Edition
United States Army Color Card, The Official Colors for Branches, Agencies, etc.

(These color references can be obtained from The Color Association of the United States, 315 West 39th Street, Studio 507 New York, NY 10018, telephone: 212 947-7774, www.colorassociation.com.)

IRA GREEN, INC.

DOD Standard Shades for Heraldic Yarns for Embroidery and Ribbons, 1993 Edition

(This publication can be obtained from Ira Green, Inc., 177 Georgia Avenue, Providence, RI 02905.)

2.4 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein (except for related associated specifications or specification sheets),

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

the text of' this document takes precedence unless otherwise noted. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Specification sheets. The individual item requirements shall be as specified herein and in accordance with the applicable specification sheet. In the event of any conflict between the requirements of this specification and the specification sheet, the latter shall govern.

3.2 Drawings. Drawings 5-5-2, 5-5-2A, and 5-5-614 are shown as Figures 1, 2, and 3 for information purposes only. In the event of any conflict between the figures and the actual drawings, especially upon revision of the drawings, the actual drawings shall govern.

3.2A First article. When specified (see 6.2), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection in accordance with 4.3.

3.3 Recycled, recovered, or environmentally preferable materials. Recycled, recovered, or environmentally preferable materials should be used to the maximum extent possible provided that the material meets or exceeds the operational and maintenance requirements and promotes economically advantageous life cycle costs.

3.4 Materials. Materials shall be as specified herein.

3.4.1 Ribbon. The rayon ribbon for the streamers shall conform to MIL-DTL-11589. The individual colors of the yarn used in the ribbon shall conform to the cable numbers designated by the Department of Defense Standard Shades for Heraldic Yarns for Embroidery and Ribbons, 1993 Edition, as specified in the individual specification sheet.

3.4.2 Grommet. Grommets shall be a commercial brass plain grommet, Trade Size 0 with a plain washer.

3.4.3 Thread.

3.4.3.1 Cotton. The cotton thread shall conform to mercerized cotton thread IC1 or IC2 ticket number 000 of A-A-52094.

3.4.3.2 Rayon. The rayon thread shall be semi-dull continuous filament, regenerated, cellulose type rayon, two ply, 150 denier.

3.4.3.3 Polyester. The polyester shall be a natural soft multiple cord and conform to Type I, Class 1, Subclass A, Tex size 30 of MIL-DTL-32072.

3.4.3.4 Color. The color of the thread for the hem, inscription and devices shall be as specified on the applicable drawing and specification sheet unless otherwise specified (see 6.2). The bobbin thread shall be the same shade as the embroidery device or lettering.

3.5 Design. Unless otherwise indicated on the applicable specification sheet, the design and size of the streamers shall be as indicated on TIOH Drawing 5-5-2 (Figure 1). Dimensions of the letters and numerals shall be as shown on TIOH Drawing 5-5-614

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(Figure 3). Design and dimensions of devices for the streamers will be in accordance with TIOH Drawing 5-5-2A (Figure 2) and government cartoons.

3.6 Construction.

3.6.1 Fly end. Unless otherwise indicated on the applicable specification sheet, the fly end of the streamer shall be formed as shown in TIOH Drawing 5-5-2 (Figure 1) by using a Type 304 stitch of ASTM-D6193 with 58 stitches per inch ± 4 stitches per inch. The ribbon shall be closely trimmed along the stitch to form the swallow-tail of the fly end.

3.6.2 Heading.

3.6.2.1 Type I and Type II, Sizes 1 and 2. Unless otherwise indicated on the applicable specification sheet, Type I and Type II, Size 1 and 2 headings shall be constructed as shown on the applicable drawing and as specified herein. A one-inch hem shall be made using Stitching Type EFaa-2, Stitch Type 301 of ASTM-D6193 with a minimum of 12 stitches per inch. A grommet as specified in 3.4.2 shall be positioned on the heading as shown on TIOH Drawing 5-5-2 (Figure 1).

3.6.2.2 Type II, Size 3. Unless otherwise indicated on the applicable specification sheet, Type II, Size 3 heading shall be lined with a 1-1/4 inch wide cotton tape, 4-1/2 inches long and stitched on each side with Stitching Type EFa-1, Stitch Type 301 of ASTM-D6193, 12 stitches per inch. A 1/2 inch eyelet will be centered on the heading as shown on TIOH Drawing 5-5-2 (Figure 1). The eyelet shall be stitched through both layers of fabric with a regular button hole stitch. The heading shall then be formed by hemming the end of the streamer with a 3/8 inch turn under and stitched with Stitching Type EFb-2, Stitch Type 301 of ASTM-D6193. Stitching gauge shall be 1/16 inch with a 1/8 inch margin. The flat width of the finish hem shall be not less than 2-1/4 inches and turned to the reverse side of the finished streamer.

3.6.3 Embroidery. Unless otherwise indicated on the applicable specification sheet, lettering, devices, and numbers shall be positioned on the streamer as shown on TIOH Drawing 5-5-2 (Figure 1). Embroidery yarn shall conform to the requirements indicated in 3.4.3. Devices shall conform to the cartoon; however, letter size and dimensions shall be as shown on TIOH Drawing 5-5-614 (Figure 3). Tolerances for embroidered letters, numerals, and devices shall be ± 1/16 inch in height and width.

3.7 Workmanship. Streamers shall be clean, well-made and shall meet acceptable quality standards established by this specification. Thread tension shall be maintained throughout and all threads ends or cross over stitches shall be trimmed.

4. VERIFICATION

4.1 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).

b. Conformance inspection (see 4.4).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.2 Inspection conditions. Unless otherwise specified, all inspection shall be performed in accordance with the test conditions specified in 4.4.

4.3 First article inspection. Inspection and testing of the first article (see 3.2 and 6.3) shall be made of a completely finished item for all provisions of this specification applicable to the end product examination and tests.

4.4 Conformance inspection. Quality assurance inspection of components and materials shall be in accordance with the subsidiary specifications and drawings. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with ANSI/ASQC Z1.4.

4.4.1 Certificate of compliance. Grommets specified in 3.3.2 may be accepted on the basis of the contractor's certificate of compliance for requirements specified.

4.4.2 In-process inspection. In-process inspection shall be made at any point or during any phase of the manufacturing process to determine whether operation or assemblies are accomplished as specified. The Government reserves the right to exclude from consideration for acceptance any material for which in-process inspection has indicated nonconformance. In-process inspection shall be conducted to see that accomplishment of the following is in accordance with the specification requirements.

REQUIREMENT, OPERATION OR ASSEMBLY	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH
Ribbon	3.4.1
Thread checked at machine	3.4.3
Fly end construction	3.6.1
Heading construction	3.6.2
Turn-in, Turn under of seams	3.6.2
Embroidery design	3.6.3

4.5. Inspection of the end item. A one hundred percent inspection shall be performed on end item streamers.

4.5.1 Visual examination of streamers. Examination of streamers for defects in design, material, construction and workmanship shall be made using Table 1. Examination shall be made at a distance of approximately 16 to 22 inches with illumination equal to average daylight and arranged so as to avoid as much reflected light as possible. Defects designated by an asterisk (*) shall be classified as major when seriously affecting appearance or serviceability and minor when affecting appearance or serviceability but not seriously. The unit of product for the examinations shall be one completely fabricated streamer. Any dimension which is not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. **CLASSIFICATION OF VISUAL DEFECTS**

EXAMINE	DEFECT	CLASSIFICATION		
		MAJOR	(*	MINOR
Quality of ribbon:				
Type	Ribbon not as specified	X		
Color	Color other than specified	X		
	Off shade		*	
Material	Hole, cut, tear, smash or weak place	X		
	Spot, stain, streak		*	
	Two or more continuous broken or missing ends	X		
	Double pick, course pick or mis-pick clearly noticeable	X		
	Float or skip		*	
	Crease or wrinkle embedded		*	
Quality of grommet	Broken, cracked or malformed	X		
	Contains rough or sharp edge			X
Construction and workmanship	Operation omitted or not accomplished as specified		*	
	Component is not required type, style, or size required	X		
	Ribbon not continuous length	X		
Stitches, seams, and stitching	Incorrect color thread	X		
	Thread shade color not a good match		*	
	Incorrect type of seams, stitch or stitching		*	
	Row of stitches partially or completely missing		*	
	Seams improperly formed	X		
	Tight or loose tension		*	
	Broken stitches			X
	Hem uneven		*	
Embroidered design – stars, letters, device, etc. .	Broken stitches		*	
	Not positioned correctly		*	
	Design not as specified		*	
	Color not as specified		*	
	Cross over stitches and stubs not properly trimmed		*	
Heading	Grommet not properly positioned		*	
	Stitching for eyelet not as specified		*	
	Stitching for eyelet not sewn completely	X		
Dimensions of streamer	Overall length not as specified	X		
	Ribbon width varies more than 1/16 inch from size specified	X		
	Embroidered design unequally spaced or out of balance	X		
	Incorrect embroidered design size greater than 1/8 inch	X		

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When actual packaging of materiel is to be performed by DoD personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain requisite packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activity within the Military Department or Defense Agency, or within the Military Department's System Command. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The streamers are designed for display with military flags to indicate service participation or awards by the military service or unit. Type I streamer sets are intended for display on the service flags. Type II individual streamers are for display by units.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of the specification.

b. Issue of DoDISS to be cited in the solicitation, and . . .. **DELETED** If required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1).

c. The number and date of the applicable specification sheet (see 1.2 and 2.1) with width of ribbon.

d. When a first article is not required (see 3.2).

e. Packaging requirements (see 5.1).

6.3 First article. When first article inspection is required, the contracting officer should provide specific guidance to offerors whether the item should be a preproduction sample, a first production sample, or a standard production item from the contractor's current inventory as specified in 4.4. The first article should consist of one completed item. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examination, approval of first article test results, and disposition of first articles. Invitations for bids should provide that the Government reserves the right to waive the requirement for samples for first article inspection to those bidders offering a product which has been previously acquired or tested by the Government, and that bidders offering such products, who wish to rely on such production or tests, must furnish evidence with the bid that prior Government approval is presently appropriate for the pending contract.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Decoration
Service Ribbon
Service Medal
Campaign Medal

6.5 The following [soft] metric conversions apply within this document:

INCHES	CENTIMETERS
1/16	0.159
1/8	0.318
1/2	1.27
1 1/4	3.175
2 1/4	5.715
4 1/2	11.43
16	40.64
22	55.88

6.6 The margins of this specification are marked with vertical lines to indicate modifications generated by this amendment. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations.

Custodians:
Army - IH
Air Force - 11
Navy - NU

Preparing activity:
Army - IH

Review activities:
Navy – MC
Navy - CG
DLA – CT

(Project No. 8345-0239/001)

NOTE: The activities listed above were interested in this document as of the date of this document. Since organizations and responsibilities can change, you should verify the currency of the information above using the ASSIST Online database at www.dodssp.daps.mil.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

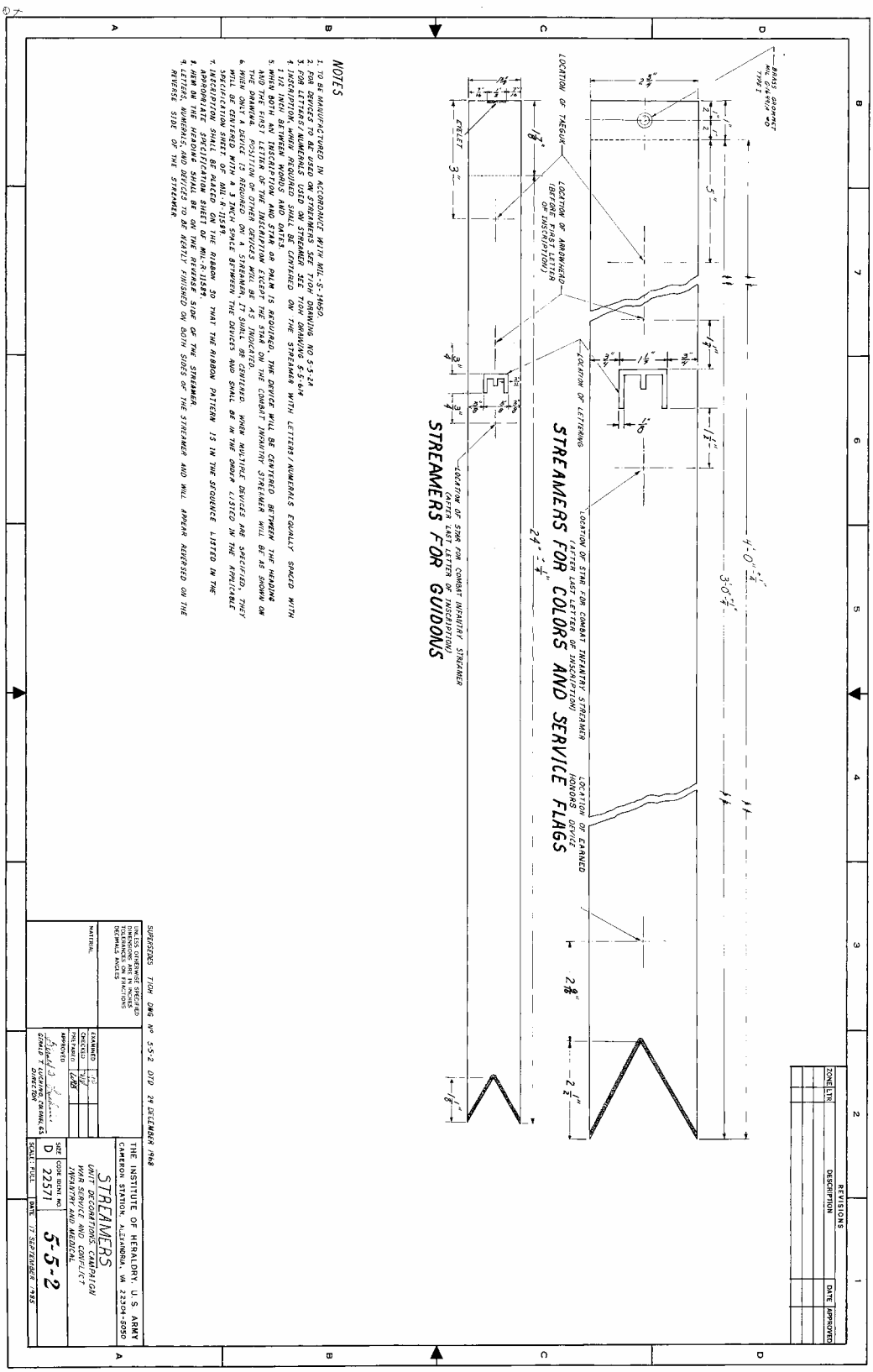


FIGURE 1. **Streamers.**

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

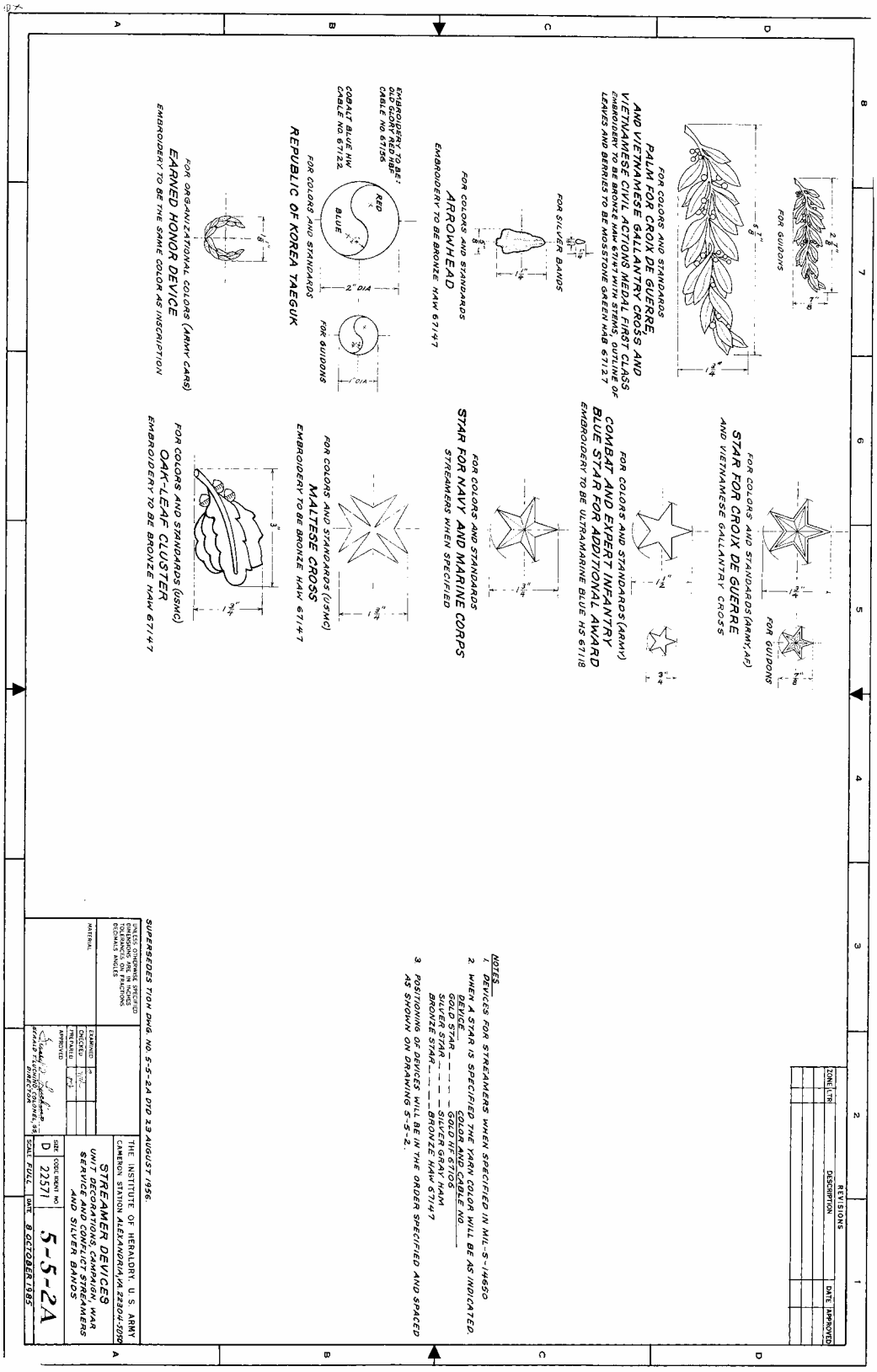


FIGURE 2. **Streamer devices.**

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

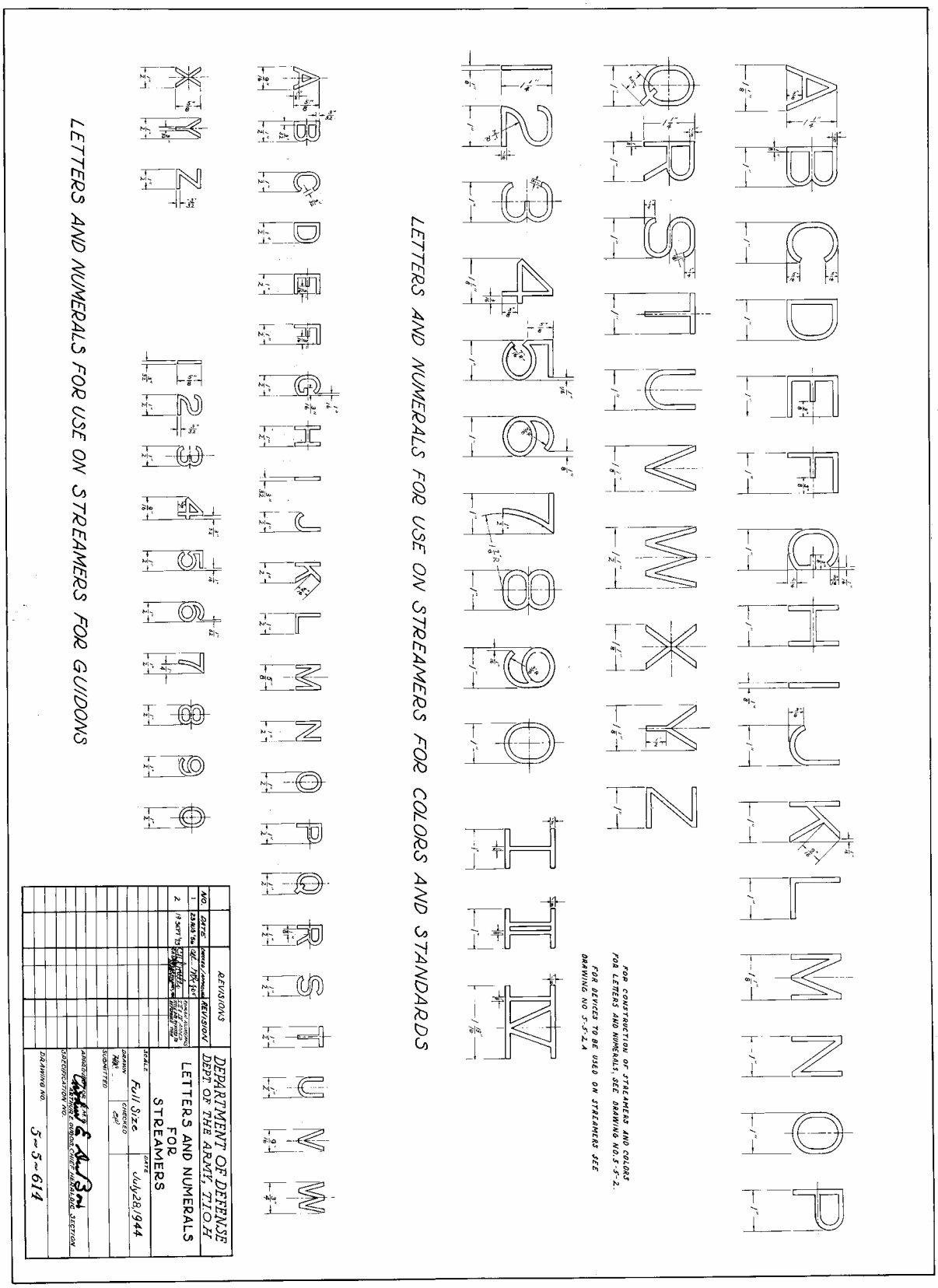


FIGURE 3. **Letters and numerals for streamers.**

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:21Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.